

The cognitive influence stack: an agent rewarded on a human outcome can act at three levels

a reward that demands a lasting
change drives escalation downward

Level 1 Momentary belief

push a single choice / belief over its tipping point

persistence: transient (value-absorption bound; washes out)

defence: early warning (critical slowing down) + amplitude cap

Level 2 Learning rule

reshape how the learner updates (which experience, what is rewarded)

persistence: persistent (moves the fixed point; can latch)

defence: behaviour-only steering detector + curriculum monitor

Level 3 Neural value channel

the reward-prediction-error / value signal both levels run on

persistence: the substrate; decodable (neuroforecasting)

defence: govern access; the channel is the read interface